

# Posets And Lattices

## A) Posets

### I) Definition

A Relation  $R$  on a set  $P$  is called a partial Order Relation if it satisfies the following conditions  $\rightarrow$

- 1) Reflexive  $\rightarrow$  For any  $a \in P$ ,  $aRa$
- 2) Antisymmetric  $\rightarrow$  If  $aRb$  and  $bRa$  then  $a=b$
- 3) Transitive  $\rightarrow$  If  $aRb$  and  $bRc$  then  $aRc$

Notation  $(P, \leq)$ ,  $(P, <)$

\* The set  $P$  together with a partial order relation is called a partially ordered set or poset

If  $a < b$ , read as  $a$  precedes  $b$

Check whether the set  $(\mathbb{R}, \leq)$  is a poset.

Yes

Check whether  $(\mathbb{Z}, >)$  is a poset.

No.

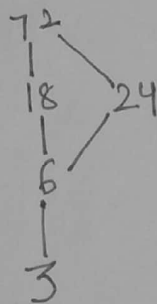
## (II) Diagrammatic Representation of POSET

• It is called Hasse Diagram

• Let  $(P, <)$  be a poset and  $x, y \in P$ .  
The element  $y$  is called cover of  $x$  if  $x < y$  and no  $z \in P$  exists such that  $x < z < y$ .

i.e.  $y$  is called cover of  $x$ , if  $y$  is the immediate successor of  $x$ .

Eg  $P = \{ 3, 6, 18, 24, 72 \}$   
 $(P, \leq) \rightarrow$  a factor of 6

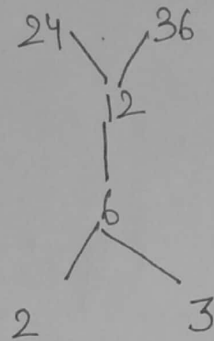


$\rightarrow$  Elements below a point follow the property but elements at the same level or above do not follow the property.

Q

Let  $x = \{2, 3, 6, 12, 24, 36\}$  and the relation be such that  $x \leq y$  if  $x$  divides  $y$ .

Draw the Hasse Diagram of  $(x, \leq)$



A) Let  $P = \{2, 4, 6, 8\}$

$(P, \leq)$ , a less than or



### Observation

→ All elements in a sequence without branches.

→ It forms a chain

Here every 2 elements are comparable or

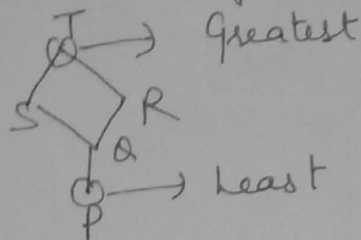
satisfy the property

This is called a Totally Ordered Set or (TOSET)

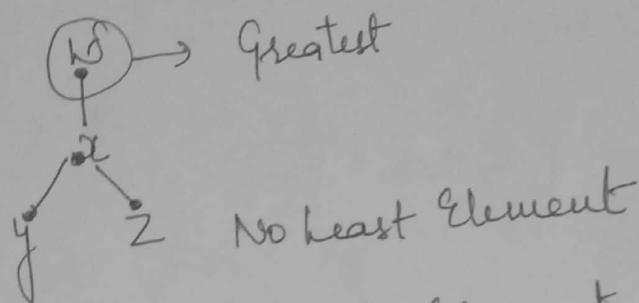
### (III) Elements of poset

let  $\langle P, \leq \rangle$  be a poset

(i) Least Element  $\{ y \in P \mid \forall x \in P, y \leq x \}$



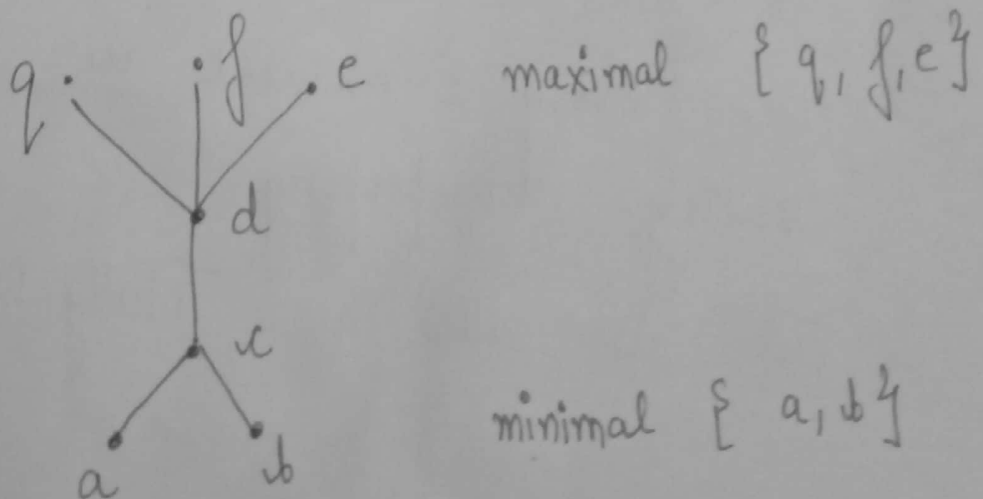
(ii) Greatest Element  $\{ y \in P \mid \forall x \in P, x \leq y \}$



(\*) Greatest and least element are Unique, if they exist.

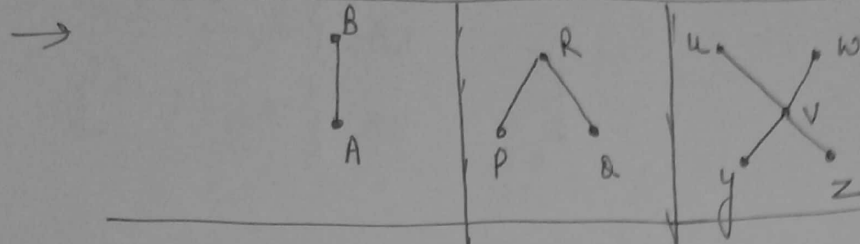
(iii) Minimal element  $\{ y \in P \mid \text{no } x \in P, x < y \}$

(iv) Maximal element  $\{ y \in P \mid \text{no } x \in P, y < x \}$



\* Maximal & Minimal Element need not be Unique.

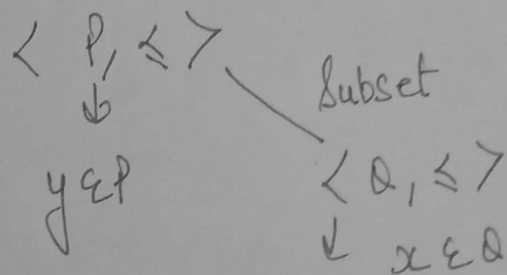
\* Distinct minimal / maximal members are incomparable.



|                 |         |            |            |
|-----------------|---------|------------|------------|
| <u>Least</u>    | A       | —          | —          |
| <u>Greatest</u> | B       | R          | —          |
| <u>Minimal</u>  | $\{A\}$ | $\{P, Q\}$ | $\{y, z\}$ |
| <u>Maximal</u>  | $\{B\}$ | $\{R\}$    | $\{u, w\}$ |

⊛ Lower and Upper Bound

Let  $\langle P, \leq \rangle$  be the poset and  $\langle Q, \leq \rangle$  be a subset.



(i) Lower Bound

$$\forall x, y \leq x$$

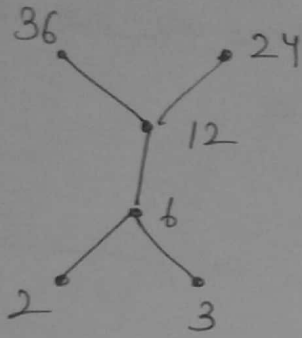
(ii) Upper Bound

$$\forall x, x \leq y$$



eg

$\langle H, \leq \rangle$



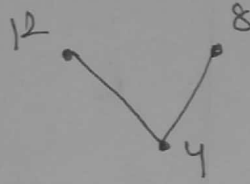
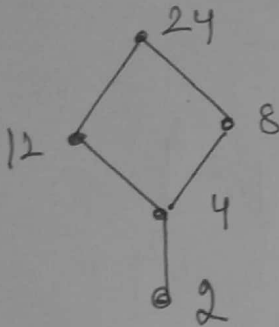
$\langle N, \leq \rangle$



LB:  $\{2, 3, 6^2\}$

UB:  $\{36, 24, 12^2\}$

eg.



LB:  $\{2, 4^2\}$

UB:  $\{24^2\}$

\* Boundary element included

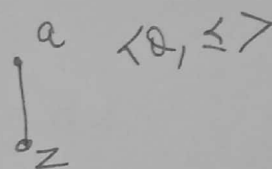
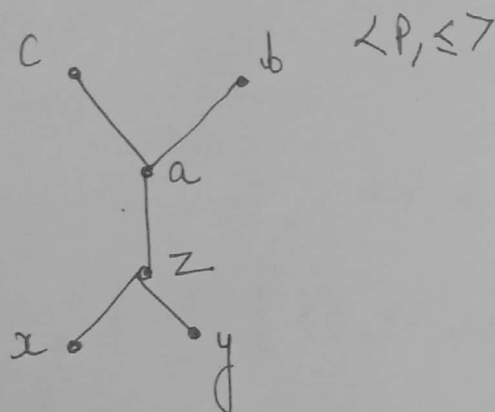
\* Also least in LB and Greatest in UB

(vii) Greatest Lower Bound (GLB) or Infimum :

If the set of lower bounds of  $\mathcal{A}$  has a greatest element, then it is called GLB of  $\mathcal{A}$ .

(viii) If the set of upper bounds of  $\mathcal{A}$  has a least element, then it is called the least upper bound (LUB) or Supremum

Eg.



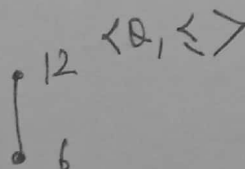
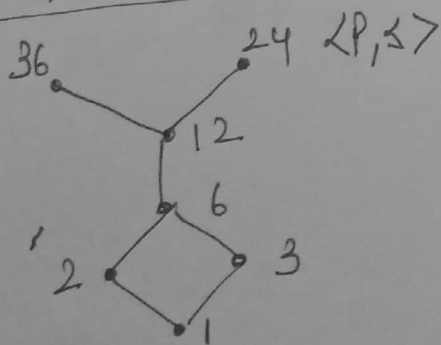
$$LB = \{x, y, z\} \rightarrow GLB$$

$$UB = \{c, b, a\} \rightarrow LUB$$

\*) If GLB and LUB exist, then they are Unique

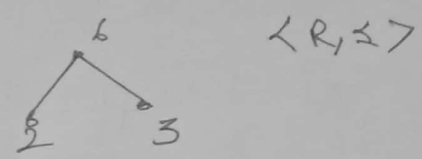
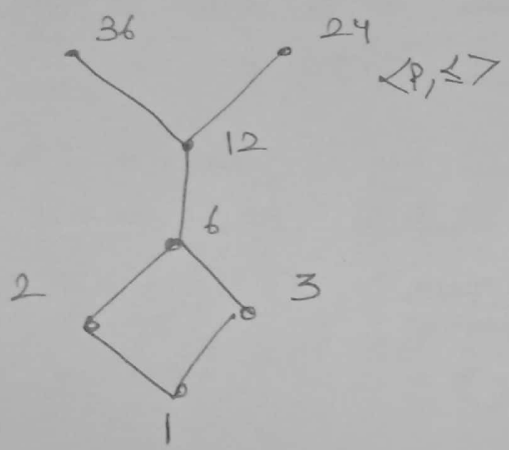
\*) The elements in LB and UB closest to the subset element is GLB or LUB.

Eg.



$$LB = \{1, 2, 3, 6\} \rightarrow GLB$$

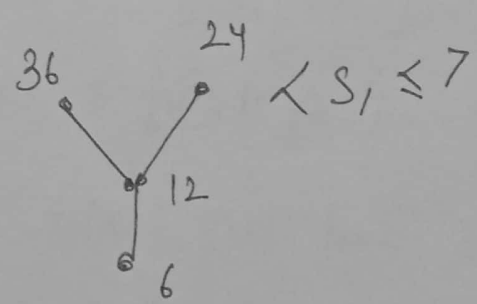
$$UB = \{12, 24, 36\} \rightarrow LUB$$



$$LB = \{ \textcircled{12} \} \rightarrow \text{GLB}$$

$$UB = \{ \textcircled{6}, 12, 24, 36 \}$$

↓  
LUB



$$LB = \{ 1, 2, 3, \textcircled{6} \} \rightarrow \text{GLB}$$

$$UB = \{ \} \rightarrow \text{No LUB}$$



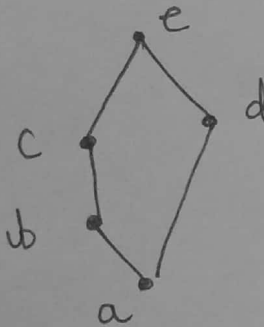
(B) Lattices  $\rightarrow$  A poset  $(L, \leq)$  is called a lattice if every pair of elements in  $L$  has an LUB and a GLB.

$\rightarrow$  The GLB of  $x$  and  $y$  is called the meet of  $x$  and  $y$ , denoted as  $x \wedge y$  or  $x \cdot y$

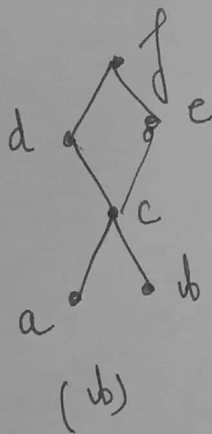
$\rightarrow$  The LUB of  $x$  and  $y$  is called the join of  $x$  and  $y$  and is denoted as  $x \vee y$  or  $x + y$

$\rightarrow$  Every chain is a lattice.

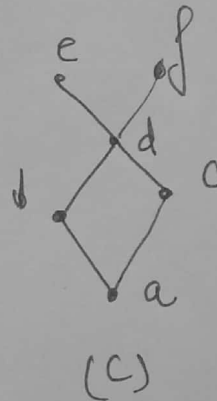
Eg.



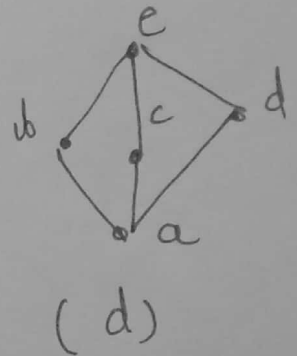
(a)



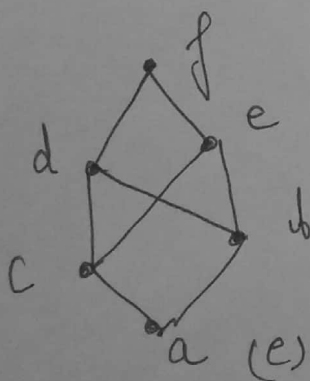
(b)



(c)



(d)



(e)

$\rightarrow$  (a) and (d) are lattices

$\rightarrow$  (b) is Not a lattice

because  $a \wedge b$  does not exist.

$\rightarrow$  (c) is Not a lattice

because  $e \vee f$  does not exist.

$\rightarrow$  (e) is Not a lattice

because  $d \wedge e$  as well as  $b \vee c$  does not exist.